

CHOOSING THE RIGHT AUTHENTICATOR APP

There are several to choose from, but we recommend Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy and Duo Mobile. It depends on your individual needs and preferences. Consider factors like:

- **Ease of use:** If you prioritise a simple and straightforward interface, Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator might be suitable.
- **Multi-device compatibility:** If you need access across various devices, options like Microsoft Authenticator or Authy offer broader platform support.
- **Security features:** For advanced security needs, Duo Mobile caters well with its range of authentication methods.
- **Password management integration:** If you already use a password manager like Last-Pass, its integrated authenticator might be a convenient choice.

Remember, enabling 2FA on your online accounts significantly enhances security by adding an extra layer of protection beyond just passwords.

QUICK TIPS FOR SAFE AND SECURE ONLINE BROWSING

- **Always update:** Keep your web browser, operating system, and security software up-to-date. These updates patch vulnerabilities that hackers exploit, acting as your digital armour.
- **Shield Your Connection:** Avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive activities. Public Wi-Fi can be a gateway for eavesdroppers. If public Wi-Fi is your only option, consider using a VPN to encrypt your connection.
- **HTTPS Everywhere:** Look for the "https://" prefix before website addresses. This signifies a secure connection, making it harder for attackers to steal your information.
- **Password Powerhouse:** Use strong, unique passwords for every account. Avoid using personal details and consider a password manager to create and store complex passwords securely.
- **Beware of Phishing:** Be cautious of emails or messages urging immediate action, containing suspicious attachments, or originating from unknown senders. Don't click on links or share personal information unless you're certain of the sender's legitimacy.

tion protects your data from interception during transmission, forming an essential first line of online defence that's indispensable. According to the Web Technology Survey's HTTPS report, 81% of websites use HTTPS by default nowadays, but you still have to stay vigilant about the rest. Most modern web browsers detect and flag up non-HTTPS connections to web pages, urging caution to users who inadvertently land up on them.



Using Privacy-Enhancing Tools

- **Ad Blockers:** Install ad blockers to prevent malicious ads from compromising your security.
- **Privacy-Focused Browsers:** Consider browsers dedicated to privacy that offer built-in security features.
- **Incognito Mode:** Use incognito or private browsing modes to minimise data retention on your device, though remember it doesn't hide your activity from websites or your internet service provider.

Avoiding Malicious Websites

Look out for red flags indicating a website may be malicious, such as poor design, excessive pop-ups, or a lack of secure connection. Utilise browser security extensions that alert you to known dangerous sites.

By adhering to these practices and continually educating yourself on the evolving landscape of online threats, you can significantly reduce your risk of falling victim to cyber attacks. Remember, the goal of personal security measures is not just to react to threats, but to proactively prevent them, ensuring a safer online experience for you and your digital community. **d**